Template

Brainstorm & idea prioritization

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

10 minutes to prepare
1 hour to collaborate
2-8 people recommended

Before you collaborate

A little bit of preparation goes a long way with this session. Here's what you need to do to get going.

10 minutes

Team gathering
Define who should participate in the session and send an invite. Share relevant information or pre-work ahead.

Set the goal
Think about the problem you'll be focusing on solving in the brainstorming session.

Learn how to use the facilitation tools
Use the Facilitation Superpowers to run a happy and productive session.

Open article

1 Define your problem statement

What problem are you trying to solve? Frame your problem as a How Might We statement. This will be the focus of your brainstorm.

5 minutes

PROBLEM
How might we [your problem statement]?

Key rules of brainstorming

To run an smooth and productive session

- Stay in topic.
- Defer judgment.
- Go for volume.
- Encourage wild ideas.
- Listen to others.
- If possible, be visual.

2 Brainstorm

Write down any ideas that come to mind that address your problem statement.

10 minutes

TIP
You can select a sticky note and hit the pencil [switch to sketch] icon to start drawing!

Person 1

- Train staff on proper food storage and preparation techniques
- Improve communication and coordination between kitchen and front-of house staff
- Hire more staffs during peak hours

Person 2

- Offer smaller portion sizes and encourage customers to take home leftovers
- Implement a better inventory management system to track food usage and expiration dates.
- Invest in kitchen automation technology.

Person 3

- Analyze costs and identity areas where they can be reduced
- Increase sales by offering new menu items
- Recognize and reward employees for their hard work.

Person 4

- Create a positive work environment with opportunities for growth and development.
- Offer compensation to customers who have had a bad experience.
- Offer competitive pay and benefits

3 Group ideas

Take turns sharing your ideas while clustering similar or related notes as you go. Once all sticky notes have been grouped, give each cluster a sentence-like label. If a cluster is bigger than six sticky notes, try and see if you and break it up into smaller sub-groups.

20 minutes

TIP
Add customizable tags to sticky notes to make it easier to find, browse, organize, and categorize important ideas as themes within your mural.

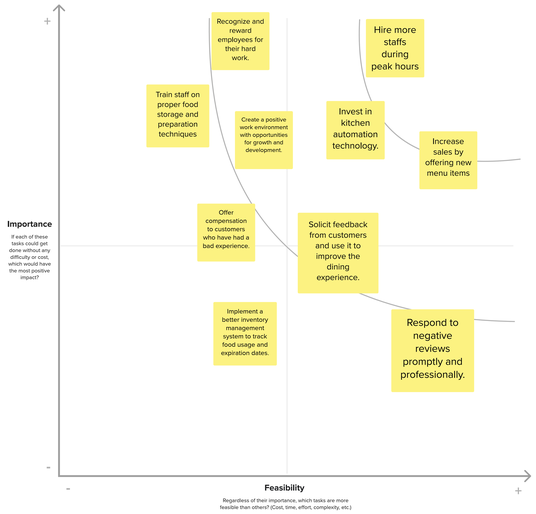
- Solicit feedback from customers and use it to improve the dining experience.
- Respond to negative reviews promptly and professionally.
- Themed restaurants can be a lot of fun, especially if the dining with kids.
- Pop-up restaurants are a great way to try new and innovative cuisine.
- Food halls are another great option for finding a variety of cuisines.
- Ask customers about their ietary restrictions when they make a reservation.

4 Prioritize

Your team should all be on the same page about what's important moving forward. Place your ideas on this grid to determine which ideas are important and which are feasible.

20 minutes

TIP
Participants can use their cursors to point at where sticky notes should go on the grid. The facilitator can confirm the spot by using the laser pointer holding the **H key** on the keyboard.



After you collaborate

You can export the mural as an image or pdf to share with members of your company who might find it helpful.

Quick add-ons

Share the mural
Share a view link to the mural with stakeholders to keep them in the loop about the outcomes of the session.

Export the mural
Export a copy of the mural as a PNG or PDF to attach to emails, include in slides, or save in your drive.

Keep moving forward

Strategy blueprint
Define the components of a new idea or strategy.
Open the template

Customer experience journey map
Understand customer needs, motivations, and obstacles for an experience.
Open the template

Strengths, weaknesses, opportunities & threats
Identify strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats (SWOT) to develop a plan.
Open the template

Share template feedback

Need some inspiration?
See a finished version of this template to kickstart your work.
Open example